

Chapter-1

DETERMINERS

Look at the sentences given below carefully :

1. You take *an* apple every day.
2. He is popular in *this* class.
3. I have *little* money to help you.
4. Give me *that* pen.
5. Our team won *the* match.
6. *These* mangoes are green.
7. *Each* boy got a packet of sweets.
8. There is not *any* ink in *this* ink-pot.
9. I do not see *any* sense in going there now.
10. *Every* student was given a book.

In all these sentences, the words in *italic* type indicate that a noun is going to be used. These words **determine the position** of a noun. Such words are called Determiners.

Kinds of Determiners :

Determiners

1	2	3
Article a, an, the	Demonstratives this, that, these, those	Possessives my, her, his, him, our, their, etc.
4	5	6
Numerical One, two, first, both, none, few, a few, each, every, either, neither	Quantitative some, any, much, more, less, little, a little, the little	Wh-Words what (ever), which (ever), whosoever, whose

USE OF ARTICLES:

‘A’ and ‘an’ are Indefinite Articles.

USE OF 'A'

Article 'A' is used :

- (i) before singular common nouns not beginning with a vowel sound e.g :
a boy, a table, a young man, a year, a useful thing, a utensil, a European country, a history book, a one-eyed man etc.
- (ii) In the sense of any, every or single:
He did not speak *a* word.
He makes thirty thousands *a* year.
- (iii) before a Proper Noun to make it a Common Noun
He is *a* Milton (an inspired poet).
He is *a* second Newton (a great scientist).

USE OF 'AN'

- (i) Before a Common noun in Singular form beginning with vowel sound, as:
an orange, an egg, an owl, an umbrella, an ass, an inkpot, an M.L.A., an S.D.O., an enemy.
- (ii) Before a Common noun in Singular form beginning with silent 'h':
an honest man, an honourable man, an heir.

USE OF THE DEFINITE ARTICLE 'THE':

The Definite Article (the) is used in the following cases:

- (i) For a particular person, thing or animal that has already been mentioned:
I have *a* coat.
The coat has *a* pocket.
The pocket has *a* pen in it.
The pen is blue in colour.
- (ii) To denote the whole class:
The dog is a faithful animal.
The camel is, the ship of *the* desert.
- (iii) Before Adjectives in the Superlative Degree:
He is *the* best man in the city.
She is *the* most beautiful girl in the town.
- (iv) Before Comparatives :
The higher you go, *the* cooler it is.
This is *the* better of the two pens.
- (v) In certain phrases :
You met him on *the* way.

She is on *the* point of death.

Rajan will win in *the* long run.

You are in *the* wrong.

Crime is on *the* decrease.

On *the* whole the scheme is good.

- (vi) Before words indicating number, weight and measure :

Cloth is sold by *the* metre.

Oranges are sold by *the* dozen.

- (vii) Before words denoting well-known historical events:

The French Revolution, *The* Partition of India,

The Liberation of Bangla Desh.

- (viii) Before the names of rivers, canals, ranges, sacred books, oceans, mountains, islands, a few countries and states where the names are descriptive, trains, buildings etc.:

the Himalayas, *the* Sutlej, *the* Punjab, *the* United States of America, *the* U.K., *the* Indian ocean, *the* Bhakhra Canal, *the* Gita, *the* Tribune, *the* Taj, *the* Golden Temple, *the* Shan-E-Punjab, *the* Gnat etc.

- (ix) Before a Proper Noun used as a Common Noun, before a Common Noun used as an Abstract Noun:

Lala Lajpat Rai was *the* lion of *the* Punjab. Kalidas is called *the* Shakespeare of India.

Gandhi ji is *the* father (= having the quality of) of *the* nation.

The beast (=bestly quality) in man sometimes overpowers *the* angel (angelic quality) in him.

He is *the* star of *the* family.

- (x) To give superlative force to Noun:

He is *the* professor. (= the best)

He is *the* hero of the home. (=the best)

It is *the* event of the year. (=the best)

- (xi) Before high titles of honour and rank:

Pitt *the* younger, *the* Great Caesar, *The* Honourable Minister, *The* Immortal Shakespeare, Alexander *the* Great.

- (xii) Before the names of communities , nations and commissions:

The Sikhs, *the* English, *the* Sarkaria Commission.

- (xiii) Before unique objects and objects of strength:

The moon, *the* earth, *the* sky, *the* tempest.

- (xiv) Before ordinals:

The 3rd prize, *the* second son, *the* fourth girl, *the* 10th of June.

- (xv) Before the organs of the body:
The head, the heart, the liver, the lungs.
- (xvi) Before a thing which stands for the agent, or the thing associated:
The pen (=those who use the pen) is mightier than the sword (=those who use the sword).
The hand (mother) that rocks the cradle rules the world.
He is fond of *the* bottle (=liquor).
- (xvii) Before an Adjective to make it a Noun in the Plural:
The rich must help the poor.
The educated should teach the illiterate.
- (xviii) Before an Adverb in such sentences as:
The more they get, the more they want.
The more you speak, the less I understand.

Cases Where Articles Should Not Be Used

- (i) Before a common Noun used in its widest sense:
Animals have an undeveloped brain.
Man is mortal.
- (ii) Before Proper Nouns:
Tagore was truly a great poet.
Everest is the highest peak in the world.
Delhi is the capital of India.
Stalin was a ruthless dictator.

Note: *'The' is not used before the names of individual peaks.*

- (iii) In certain Verbal Phrases:
Rajesh *sent word* that he was going to Mumbai.
(not 'sent a word')
Don't *take offence* so easily.
Raju *left* school at an early age.
Don't *lose* heart.
The ship *set sail* for Australia.

- (iv) Before Abstract Nouns:
Wisdom is better than riches.
Common sense is as great virtue.
Patience and *perseverance* can conquer all obstacles.
- (v) Before Material Nouns:
Iron is a useful metal.
This pillar is made of *concrete*.
There are idols made of *silver* and *gold* in the temple.

USE OF NUMERICAL AND QUANTITATIVE:

Determiners and Wh-determiners

1. Some and Any

Some means a small number. *Some* is followed by an *Uncountable Singular Noun* or *Countable Plural Noun*. When used with a *Plural Noun* it means 'a few' or a small number.

Examples :

- | | |
|--|--------------------|
| (i) He bought <i>some</i> mangoes. | (a small number) |
| (ii) Give me <i>some</i> milk. | (a small quantity) |
| (iii) There are <i>some</i> boys in the class. | (a few) |
| (iv) There is <i>some</i> ink in the ink-pot. | (a small amount) |

Generally *some* is used in affirmative statement while *any* is used in negative statement or questions.

Examples:

- | | |
|---|---------------|
| (i) There are <i>some</i> good girls in the class. | (Affirmative) |
| (ii) Are there <i>any</i> good girls in the class? | (Question) |
| (iii) There are not <i>any</i> good girls in the class. | (Negative) |
| (iv) There is <i>some</i> tea in the cup. | (Affirmative) |
| (v) Is there <i>any</i> tea in the cup? | (Question) |
| (vi) There is not <i>any</i> tea in the cup. | (Negative) |

2. Few, A Few, The Few

Few = very small number or zero

A Few = some

The Few = small but all the ones under reference

Examples:

- | | |
|---|-------------------------|
| (i) He has <i>few</i> friends in the city. | (almost none) |
| (ii) He does have <i>a few</i> friends in the city. | (a small number) |
| (iii) <i>The few</i> friends he has are loyal to him. | (whatever small number) |

3. **Each, Every**

Each = everyone out of a known number or group.

Every = each thing or person of the whole

- (i) *Each* player was given some prize.
- (ii) *Each* speaker will be given five minutes.
- (iii) *Every* person carried the torch.
- (iv) *Every* child likes sweets.

4. **Either, Neither**

Either = one of the two

Neither = none of the two

- (i) *Either* book is useful to me. (any one of the two)
- (ii) *Neither* house suits me. (none of the two)

5. **Little, a little, the little**

Little = very small amount, almost negligible

A little = Some amount, though not much

The little = whatever little exists, but the whole of it

- (i) There is *little* water in the jug. (very, very small or none at all)
- (ii) There is *a little* water in the jug. (some water, not much)
- (iii) I have drunk the *little* water the jug had. (whatever little it had)

Examples:

6. **Much, More, Less**

Much is generally used with uncountable singular nouns while *More* is used with uncountable singular nouns and countable plural nouns.

Examples:

He has not taken *much* water today.

You need some *more* water today.

More boys were called in to help.

We spent *less* time in Shimla than in Kufri.

If you are careful you'll have *less* trouble.

7. **Wh-words as Determiners :**

What books have you read?

Whose children are they?

Which pen do you like?

Exercises for Practice

Exercise 1

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners :

- (i) Jack was seven years old. His sister Jill was one year old. Their house was on hill. One day Jack and Jill were playing with ball. ball rolled down hill. Jack ran after it. Jill rolled down after Jack. There was road at foot of hill. ball stopped there.
- (ii) When Edison was 12 years old, he became newsboy on train that left Port Huron in evening. Edison set up a laboratory in baggage car of train because he did not want to waste time. Later he bought printing press and set it up in his laboratory on wheels. He published weekly paper, which he sold for three cents copy. At same time Edison spent of his free hours reading in Public Library.
- (iii) The old man was left with only money in the bank. He didn't spend on himself. He wanted to save for his rainy days. of his three sons bothered to care for him. He didn't want to be dependent on of them, either.

Exercise 2

Fill in the blanks with 'few', 'a few' or 'the few' :

- 1. were the words Rama spoke.
- 2. books she had were all destroyed.
- 3. He has read only poems.
- 4. friends she has are all insincere.
- 5. men can resist this temptation.
- 6. days' rest will do you good.
- 7. suggestions he gave were all accepted.
- 8. people live to be 80.
- 9. He is a man of words.
- 10. words spoken in earnest will win her to your side.

Exercise 3

Read the following passage. There is an error in each line. Underline the error and write your correction in the space provided:

There lived the poor (.....) weaver in the (.....) village. He had a daughter who was always lost in his (.....) day dreams. One day she was walking along the (.....) road. She had the (.....) basket of eggs on his (.....) head. She began to dream of a (.....) riches she would earn. Suddenly the (.....) cow hit her. His (.....) basket of eggs fell down on a (.....) road. All eggs (.....) were broken. She started crying.

Exercise 4

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

Why don't you go and get medicine? It is terrible disease. If you do not take precautions, you will have to feel sorry. I know friend of mine who is expert in treatingdisease. He lives in house situated in the street opposite Civil Hospital. Go and get medicine before it is too late.

Exercise 5

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. Have you got butter?
2. Will you give me sugar?
3. There were hardly mistakes in her essay.
4. man wishes to be happy.
5. You can go by road.
6. We haven't books.
7. How do you want?
8. He will pay price you asked.
9. She has bought pens.
10. Has he friends in the town?

Exercise 6

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners :

The day of party drew near. Matilda said to husband, "I haven't jewellery to wear, not even brooch. I shall look like perfect beggar. I would prefer not to go to party."

"You can wear fresh flowers," he suggested. But she was not convinced.

"Why don't you ask friend, Mrs. Forestier, to lend you jewellery?" he suggested.

She at once went to friend's house and returned home with lovely necklace. She attended ball and was great success.

Exercise 7

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. He is a man of words.
2. persons can keep a secret.
3. There are letters for you.

4. Give me a book; book will do.
5. What is latest information?

Exercise 8

Fill in the blanks with Suitable Determiners :

- (i) doctor was called in to see ailing old man. doctor treated him so unskillfully that man died. Thereupon family seized doctor and tied him to post, intending to punish him.
- (ii) But during night, he got loose from cord that held him, and escaped by swimming across Ganges. On reaching his home doctor found his son studying some medical books. "My son", said he, "do not be in hurry to study books. first and most important thing for doctor to do is to learn to swim."

Exercise 9

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. pen will do.
2. Did you see girls there?
3. Are there pens in that drawer?
4. She hasn't money.
5. How pounds of sugar do you want?
6. Delhi is from Mumbai than Surat.
7. The thief was taken to police station.
8. He does not sell than five kilograms of sugar.
9. He wasted the money he had.
10. There are books in the library.

Exercise 10

Fill in the blanks with 'Each', 'Every', 'Either' or 'Neither':-

1. of the two boys was fined.
2. seat in the hall was occupied.
3. man wants to rise in the world.
4. accusation is true.
5. soldiers was at his post.
6. side has won.
7. man has some duties to perform.
8. She visited us three days.

9. Five boys stood in row.
10. You can take side.

Exercise 11

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:-

1. Gold is precious metal.
2. Ram is pride of his parents.
3. Delhi is London of India.
4. Hari Das is loyal servant.
5. Punjabi is official language of Punjab.
6. He is man who stole my bicycle.
7. I have sent him message.
8. umbrella is essential at hill station.
9. I have Alsatian dog.
10. Gita is intelligent girl.

Exercise 12

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. He is one-eyed man.
2. Mumbai is biggest port in India.
3. He teaches me for hour.
4. India wants peace all over world.
5. dog is faithful animal.
6. I bought apple.
7. I do not lend books to anyone.
8. mother is a teacher.
9. One should do duty.
10. We love motherland.

Exercise 13

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. Is there body in the house?
2. The players had practice.
3. I have work to do.
4. He lent me books.
5. people sleep on the footpaths.

6. He gave me bananas he had.
7. June is the month of the year.
8. He has wealth than his brother.
9. little knowledge is dangerous thing.
10. I borrowed few books from him.

Exercise 14

Fill in the blanks with suitable Determiners:

1. novel is more interesting than
2. My friend is teacher.
3. She is M.L.A
4. He will leave by next train.
5. The Principal gave him warning.
6. sun rises in east.
7. eagle is a bird of prey.
8. of the girls were present.
9. He was too modest to tell lie.
10. He went to call on friends of his.